

Editorial

Let's recognise every effort to build a business around open source, learn from that experience, and get motivated to create many more.

Dear readers,

"We need more competitors in India, for us to grow."

Wow! Now, that was the quote of the month for me. What we normally get to hear is something on the lines of, "Increasing competition, means lower margins, and hence more difficulties." But then, the open source industry was never 'normal'.

As we meet more and more customers, and those who serve them—it's becoming increasingly clear that while open source offers a lot of choices to customers with respect to software solutions, the options get severely limited when they seek vendors who can implement them—especially in India. Thus, for customers, the strangle hold of 'vendor lock-in' remains.

In a nutshell, for open source to grow, we do need entrepreneurs who can bet their money and careers on their beliefs.

We started publishing the FOSS Yellow Pages (FYP) in an attempt to change precisely this scenario—to make it easy for customers to be able to locate plausible vendors for different open source solutions. Very soon, it's going to go online too, through www.linuxforu.com.

While the FYP makes it easy to locate existing vendors, what can we do to grow that list? That was the million-dollar question put forward by a member of the LFY team. Perhaps we could motivate our readers to become open source entrepreneurs, suggested someone. And, how can we go about doing that?

Turn to Page 58 for the answer to that question, where we have launched a new series of articles, which are tagged as 'success stories'.

And, it's here that we got our quote-of-the-month—from Abhas Abhinav, founder of DeepRoot Linux.

We are looking for many more such stories. While we may be able to publish just a select few in the magazine, we will surely try and cover as many as possible on www.linuxforu.com. Here's how you can help us in this initiative. If you own or work in an Indian firm that provides open source solutions—contact us. If you know of a firm that does, point it out to us. (Our e-mail ID is mentioned below.)

So bring it on, India! Let's recognise every effort to build a business around open source, learn from that experience, and get motivated to create many more.

Best Wishes!



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